



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

DELHI | Playing a Slow Hand

The Congress leadership is known to drag its feet over any major decision, be it a Cabinet reshuffle or filling a vacancy at the party headquarters. Three months after four of its nine general secretaries were given ministerial berths, the party seems in no hurry to divest them of their organisational posts, a clear divergence from the Congress's one-man one-post norm. Union ministers Ghulam Nabi Azad, Prithviraj Chavan, Mukul Wasnik and V. Narayanasamy remain party general secretaries with organisational duties. Pranab Mukherjee and C.P. Joshi continue as the Pradesh Congress Committee chiefs of West Bengal and Rajasthan. Earlier too, when Margaret Alva resigned as general secretary last year and Ashok Gehlot took over as Rajasthan's chief minister, Congress chief Sonia Gandhi took three months to replace them. And this was one of her quick decisions. Unlike the BJP that calls a meeting at the drop of every rebellion, the Congress is yet to hold an AICC session to celebrate its Lok Sabha victory. It did hold a congratulatory Working Committee meet in May though. In delaying the AICC session, many believe the Congress has lost its moment to cash in on the post-poll feel-good factor. Party leaders are again speaking of a reshuffle "anytime soon" and are hoping that their not-so-subtle hints will reach 10 Janpath.

THE CONGRESS LEADERSHIP TENDS TO TAKE ITS OWN TIME TO BRING ABOUT ANY MAJOR CHANGES

by Priya Sahgal

4

of the nine general secretaries who became ministers three months ago retain their party posts despite the Congress's norm of one-man one-post.